



PRODUCT IDEA BRIEF

Talk to your team *without the noise.*

Relay is a private team messenger. It is a quiet room for people who already work together — not a public network, not a workplace feed, and not a pile of extra tools.

August 2026 Private team conversations Product concept

1. SNAPSHOT

What Relay is

Relay is a product for teams that need to talk in the moment and then get back to work. You sign in, open a person or a group, and the conversation stays in that thread. Presence, typing, and seen receipts live next to the messages — so you know if someone is here, writing, or already read it.

2. PROBLEM

Team chat became another noisy product

Most messaging tools grew into platforms: public channels, bots, reactions, status walls, and a constant stream of things that are not a conversation. Teams still need a private place to ask a question, close a decision, or keep a small group aligned. They do not need a second homepage.

The gap is a messenger that feels complete as a product — accounts, profiles, directory, direct messages, groups — and still stays quiet.

3. SOLUTION

One workspace. Threads, not a feed.

Relay gives a team a private workspace. Members create an account, keep a profile, find people, and talk in direct or group threads. Live presence and seen receipts reduce “did you get this?” without adding another dashboard.

4. WHO IT IS FOR

People who already work together

Product teams

Launch talk, decisions, and follow-ups in one thread instead of scattered tools.

Operations

A calm channel for the people who keep the day moving.

Small companies

A company messenger without a public square or a suite of extra apps.

Admins

A people directory so membership stays clear and manageable.

5. PRODUCT PRINCIPLES

How Relay should feel

Private by default

Only people with an account in the workspace can join a conversation.

Conversation first

The main object is a thread with a person or a group — not a channel wall.

Presence in the thread

Online, typing, and seen belong next to the messages themselves.

Quiet chrome

Light and dark themes, a simple header, and no competing side products.

6. CORE PRODUCT

What ships in the first experience

Accounts

Sign up, sign in, and sign out. The workspace is yours after you create an account.

Direct messages

Start a private thread with one teammate.

Groups

Named groups with members, roles, and the ability to leave.

Live thread

Messages, typing indicators, seen receipts, and online presence.

Profile

Name, bio, and password — how you appear to the rest of the team.

People directory

Find teammates. Admins can keep the list tidy.

7. FIRST JOURNEYS

How a new person uses Relay

1. **Create an account** with name and email, then land in an empty, private inbox.
2. **Open a conversation** — message one person or start a named group.
3. **Talk in the moment** with typing, seen receipts, and a green presence when someone is here.
4. **Keep your profile current** so the directory stays useful for everyone else.

8. POSITIONING

What Relay is not

Relay is not a public social network, a company-wide announcement board, or an all-in-one workplace. It does not try to replace email, documents, or project boards. It is the private conversation layer next to that work.

Against noisy chat products, Relay wins by subtraction: fewer surfaces, clearer threads, and a workspace that stays inside the team.

9. SUCCESS

When the product is working

A team can create accounts, find each other, start a direct or group thread, and keep talking without leaving the conversation to check status elsewhere. New people understand the product from the home page before they sign in. The home page talks about the product — who it is for, what you can do, and why it is quieter — not about how it is built.

Relay · Product idea brief · August 2026 · For internal product and design alignment.